

User Manual

1. Getting Started

1.1 Launching the Application

Start the application from the Desktop shortcut or the Start Menu entry created by the installer ("Attendance Management System"). On first launch, you will see a license activation screen if the software has not yet been activated on this computer — enter the license key you were given and click Activate. Once activated (or on every subsequent launch once already activated), you will see the login screen.

1.2 Logging In

- 1 Select your company from the dropdown — this list shows every company registered on this installation.
- 2 Enter your username and password.
- 3 Click (Log In) تسجيل الدخول, or press Enter.

If your account has been locked after repeated failed login attempts, wait for the lockout period to pass, or contact your administrator to unlock it. Your session will automatically log out after a period of inactivity — you will be returned to the login screen and asked to sign in again.

2. The Main Window

After logging in, you land on the Dashboard. The sidebar on the right (the app runs right-to-left) lists every section you have permission to access:

- (Dashboard) لوحة التحكم — live overview.
- (Employees) الموظفون — employee records.
- (Attendance) الحضور والانصراف — punches and daily attendance.
- (Departments) الأقسام — the department tree.
- (Branches) الفروع — the company's physical locations.
- (Devices) الأجهزة — biometric device management.
- (Shifts) الورديات — work shift definitions and employee assignments.
- (Holidays) العطلات — the company holiday calendar.
- (Leave) الإجازات — leave requests and approvals.
- (Reports) التقارير — generate and export reports.
- (Users) المستخدمين — user accounts, roles, and permissions.
- (Settings) الإعدادات — company profile, preferences, backups.

The top bar shows your name and role, a theme toggle (light/dark), and a logout button. Which sections you see depends on the permissions your role has been granted — if a section is missing, ask your administrator.

3. Dashboard

The dashboard gives an at-a-glance view of the current state of your company: number of active employees, number of departments, device connection status, and a breakdown of today's attendance (present, late, absent, on leave). Below that, two executive charts show a 14-day attendance trend (present/late/absent/on leave counts per day) and your active headcount broken down by department — useful for spotting a pattern (a spike in absences, a department running short-staffed) without running a full report. The whole page refreshes automatically and requires no action from you.

4. Employees

- Search: use the search box to filter by name, employee code, or department.
- Add an employee: click Add, fill in the form (name, department, branch, shift, contact details, hire date, etc.), and save. A QR code and barcode are generated automatically for the new employee — use these on printed badges for devices/kiosks that scan codes instead of biometrics.
- Edit / deactivate: select an employee to edit their details, or deactivate them if they've left the company (deactivating preserves their historical attendance records — it does not delete anything).

5. Attendance

- Automatic: punches synced from a connected biometric device appear here automatically and are used to compute each employee's daily status (present, late, early leave, overtime) against their assigned shift.
- Manual entry: for employees without a device (or to correct a missed punch), use "Add Manual Entry" and select the employee, date, and time(s).
- Daily status is computed in your company's configured time zone, taking the employee's assigned shift, company holidays, and approved leave into account — see sections 7-9 for how those are configured.

6. Departments

Departments are organized as a tree (parent/child), matching your company's real organizational structure. You can:

- Add a department, optionally under a parent department.
- Reorder departments by dragging them within the tree.
- Assign employees to a department from the Employees screen.

7. Branches (if your company has more than one location)

Branches represent physical locations, separate from the organizational department tree — useful once your company operates from more than one site. You can:

- Add a branch (name, code, address, phone).

- Mark one branch as the company's main branch (only one can hold this designation at a time; marking a new one automatically un-marks the previous one).
- Assign employees and devices to a branch from their respective Add/Edit forms, once at least one branch exists.

If your company operates from a single location, you can ignore this screen entirely — branch assignment is optional everywhere it appears.

8. Devices

- Add a device: enter its IP address, port, and protocol (ZKTeco or Hikvision), then Test Connection to confirm the app can reach it before saving.
- Sync: pull new punch records from the device into the system. Your administrator may also have scheduled automatic sync, in which case new punches appear here without anyone clicking Sync.
- Push employees: send employee records to the device so it recognizes them at the terminal (fingerprint/face/card enrollment itself still happens on the device's own hardware).

If a device shows as disconnected, check that it's powered on and reachable on the network from the computer running this application (same subnet, or routed/firewalled to allow the connection), and that the IP/port configured here still matches the device.

9. Shifts

A shift defines a work schedule: start time, end time, a grace period before a late arrival counts as "late," and which days of the week it applies to. Define your company's shift patterns here, then assign each employee to the shift that applies to them (with an effective-from date — an employee can move to a different shift over time without losing the history of which shift was in effect on any past day). An employee's assigned shift is what daily attendance is computed against.

10. Holidays

Maintain your company's official holiday calendar here. A day marked as a holiday always computes as "holiday" status for every employee, regardless of punches — no one needs to be marked absent or have their attendance corrected for a day the company was simply closed. Holidays can be one-off or set to recur annually on the same date.

11. Leave

Submit and track leave requests here:

- 1 Select the employee, the leave policy/type, and the date range.
- 2 Submit the request.
- 3 A user with leave-approval permission reviews and approves (or rejects) it.

An approved leave request automatically makes every covered day compute as "on leave" status for that employee's attendance — no manual attendance correction needed once a request is approved.

12. Reports

Six report types are available: attendance summary, by employee, by department, late arrivals, overtime, and absences. For each:

- 1 Choose the report type and a date range (and department/employee filter, where applicable).
- 2 Click Generate.
- 3 Export to Excel, PDF, or CSV using the export buttons — PDF reports render Arabic text correctly, right-to-left, exactly as it appears elsewhere in the application.

13. Users (if you have Users management permission)

Administrators can create additional user accounts, assign them a role, and customize what each role can see and do via the permission catalog (e.g. a role that can view but not edit attendance). See the Administrator Manual for the full permissions/roles reference.

14. Settings

- Company profile: name, logo, contact details.
- Preferences: time zone, date format, currency, and other display defaults used throughout the app.
- Backup & restore: create a backup of the database on demand, or restore from a previous backup file — or leave automatic scheduled backup running, which needs no action from you once enabled. See the Administrator Manual for details and recommended backup practice.

15. Getting Help

If you encounter an error message, note exactly what it says and what you were doing when it appeared, and contact your system administrator or IT support. Application logs (useful for diagnosing issues) are stored under %LOCALAPPDATA%\AttendanceManagementSystem\logs\ on Windows.